Breast feeding

It should be initiated as early as possible after birth. The first milk which is called **"colostrum"** is the most suitable food for the baby during early period because it is rich in anti-infective factors. It contains high concentration of protein and other nutrients the baby needs.

Cord care

The stump is kept dry and clean. Nothing should be applied over stump. Bandages should not be applied. Fold diaper below stump. If the stump is wet, wash with clean water and soap, dry with clean cloth. Usually the stump will fall in 7-10 days time. If umbilicus is red or draining pus or blood, the mother should be advised to see the health worker.



Eye care

Eyes of the babies are cleaned from inner canthus to outer canthus using sterile wet gauze or cotton in the hospital and with a clean cloth at home. Nothing should be poured into the eyes of the newborn unless medically indicated.



Vitamin K injection: Vitamin K injectioning is given intra muscularly to prevent bleeding.

Care of Skin: It is advisable to postpone the formal bath to the second week. However sponge bath may be given after 24 hour of birth.

Urine and meconium: Check for passage of urine and meconium.

Immunization: Hepatitis B vaccine and zero doses of OPV and BCG is given immediately. Thereafter, the child should be immunized on specific dates.

Harmful practices which should not be followed for newborn

- Giving prelacteal feeds soon after birth like sugar water or honey or donkey milk, jaggery water.
- Discarding the colostrums (the first milk secretion from the mother)
- Applying ashes or soot or powder or dry cow dung on the umbilical cord of the baby.
- Applying kajal on the baby's face to prevent bad eye
- Tying black thread or bangles to the baby's hand or leg to prevent bad eye.
- Exposing baby to a "holy" smoke (Sambirani) after bath.
- Giving home remedies for digestion like vasambu
- Pouring of oil into eye or ear.
- Blowing of nose and ear during bath

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